

Swing Finder — Put It Online with Render

A step-by-step guide to host your stock app and get a public link to share with a friend. About 15 minutes. No prior experience needed.

Before you start (one-time setup)

You'll need two free accounts and one small tool:

- **GitHub account** — sign up at github.com/signup (this is where your code lives).
- **Render account** — sign up at render.com. Choose “**Sign up with GitHub**” to link them automatically.
- **Git installed on your computer:**

– **Mac:** open *Terminal* and type `git --version`. If it isn't installed, your Mac will offer to install it — accept.

– **Windows:** download from git-scm.com/download/win and install with the default options. This also gives you *Git Bash*.

Prefer no typing?

- You can do Steps 1–2 with the free **GitHub Desktop** app (desktop.github.com) instead of the command line — create the repo, drag in the folder, and click *Publish*. Then jump to Step 3.

Step 1. Get the project folder onto your computer

Save the file **stockpicker-app.zip** to your computer and **unzip it** (double-click on Mac; right-click → Extract All on Windows). You'll get a folder named **stockpicker**. Remember where it is.

Step 2. Create an empty repository on GitHub

Go to github.com/new and:

- **Repository name:** `swing-finder`
- Leave it **Public** or Private (either works).
- **Do NOT** check “Add a README”, “.gitignore”, or “license” — keep it empty.
- Click **Create repository**.

Step 3. Upload the code to GitHub

Open a terminal **inside the stockpicker folder**:

- **Mac:** in Terminal, type `cd` (with a space), drag the stockpicker folder onto the window, press Enter.
- **Windows:** open the stockpicker folder, right-click an empty area, choose “**Git Bash Here**”.

Then paste these commands (one block). **Replace** YOURNAME with your GitHub username:

```
git init
git add -A
git commit -m "Swing Finder"
git branch -M main
git remote add origin https://github.com/YOURNAME/swing-finder.git
git push -u origin main
```

If it asks you to sign in, a browser window will open — log in to GitHub and approve. Then refresh your GitHub repo page; you should see all the files.

Step 4. Deploy on Render

- Go to dashboard.render.com.
- Click **New +** (top right) → **Blueprint**.
- If asked, connect your GitHub and grant access, then pick the **swing-finder** repository.
- Render automatically reads the included **render.yaml** file. Click **Apply** (or **Create**).
- Wait a few minutes while it builds. The status will change to **Live**.

Step 5. Open it and share the link

- Click your service in Render. Your public web address appears at the top, like `https://swing-finder.onrender.com`.
- Open it in your browser, then click **Refresh data** to load live prices (the first refresh is slow — that's normal).
- Send that link to your friend. Done!

Good to know (free plan)

- The site **sleeps after ~15 minutes** of no use. The next visit takes 30–60 seconds to wake up — this is normal, just wait.
- Saved data (price cache & watchlist) **resets when Render restarts**. The app always shows the bundled snapshot, and **Refresh data** reloads live prices. (To keep data permanently, upgrade to a paid Render plan.)
- The price provider (Yahoo) limits requests from servers, so a full refresh on Render can be slow or partial — the built-in snapshot keeps it working.
- **You can still run it on your own computer** anytime — nothing about hosting changes that.

If something goes wrong

- **“git: command not found”** → Git isn't installed. See “Before you start”.
- **Push asks for a password and rejects it** → GitHub no longer accepts passwords here. Easiest fix: use the **GitHub Desktop** app (Step 2 callout), or when prompted choose to sign in through the browser.

- **Render build failed** → open the service's **Logs** tab in Render to see the error; usually it's a typo in the repo or a missing file. Re-push and Render redeploys automatically.
- **Page loads but tables are empty** → click **Refresh data** and wait; if Yahoo is rate-limiting, try again in a minute.

Educational tool using public data — not financial advice. Short-term trading is high-risk.